WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

ANGOLA

Africa

Information current as of October 2026

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Luanda	Capital and commercial centre; seat of government, the central bank and most banks, and the country's principal port and services hub	Financial services, trade, construction, ICT
Luanda-Bengo Special Economic Zone and Barra do Dande free zone	The country's operating special economic zone, close to the capital, complemented by the Barra do Dande free zone established in 2021	Light manufacturing, agro-processing, logistics
Lobito / Benguela (Atlantic coast)	Atlantic gateway and terminus of the Lobito Corridor, giving the Zambian and Congolese Copperbelts a western route to global markets	Port logistics, mineral exports, industry
Lobito Corridor railway (Lobito–Luau, 1,289 km)	Brownfield line under a 30-year concession, with capacity set to rise about tenfold to roughly 4.6 million tonnes a year	Rail logistics, agriculture, mining services
Offshore oil and gas provinces (incl. Cabinda Block 14)	Core of national output, with new developments such as the $6 billion Kaminho project designed to keep production above 1 million barrels a day	Upstream oil and gas, oilfield services
Lunda provinces (north-east)	Diamond heartland; output from the new Luele mine helped lift diamond exports by 21% in 2025	Diamond mining, mining services
Huambo and the central highlands	Fertile agricultural interior and home of the Longonjo rare-earths project, with only 14% of 35 million hectares of arable land currently in use	Agriculture, food processing, critical minerals

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- AIPEX (Agency for Private Investment and Export Promotion), the sole investment regulatory and promotion body, operating a Single Investment Window for incorporation, licences, visas and site identification
- Private Investment Law (Law 10/18, amended by Law 10/21), with Prior Declaration, Special and Contractual regimes; approvals not decided on time are deemed tacitly granted
- Contractual Regime for projects of at least $10 million creating 50 or more local jobs, with tax reductions of up to 15 years and customs exemptions negotiated with AIPEX under the Tax Benefits Code (Law 8/22)

- Development zones A to D offering location-based incentives, alongside the Luanda-Bengo Special Economic Zone and the Barra do Dande free zone
- Banco Nacional de Angola oversight of foreign exchange; the investment law guarantees the transfer abroad of dividends, liquidation proceeds and royalties, with the 2021 amendments removing the requirement to prove full project implementation first
- Oil and gas entry through licensing by ANPG, the national concessionaire, and partnerships with Sonangol
- PROPRIV privatisation programme, including planned partial privatisation of Sonangol and divestment of non-core state assets

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Angola in October 2026 is enjoying its strongest growth momentum in years, led by the non-oil economy. GDP expanded 7.15% in the first half of 2026, following 3.1% in 2025, with second-quarter growth of 8.74% year-on-year and the non-oil sector up 9.24%; information and communication (+19.7%), transport and storage (+14.2%) and manufacturing (+9.7%) led the first-half gains. Inflation has fallen from 13.35% in February to 8.78% in August, allowing the Banco Nacional de Angola to cut its policy rate from 17.5% to 14.75% between March and September. Non-oil foreign direct investment reached $959.4 million in 2025, up 171% and the largest jump in 13 years, while a $2.5 billion Eurobond in March 2026 drew around $5.2 billion of demand. A modernised Private Investment Law, a Single Investment Window and a new Tax Benefits Code have simplified entry.

Angola's main structural challenge is its reliance on oil, which accounts for more than 90% of exports; production of about 1.03 million barrels a day in 2025 was lower than in previous years, and the IMF has highlighted the need for diversification. The country is addressing this on two fronts. In energy, new projects such as the $6 billion Kaminho development aim to keep output above 1 million barrels a day, and Angola's exit from OPEC in December 2023 gives it greater freedom over production. Beyond oil, diamond exports rose 21% in 2025, the Longonjo rare-earths project is due to start commercial production in 2027, and the Lobito Corridor reached a $786 million financial close in 2026 to expand mineral and agricultural freight. Buffers remain sound: reserves stood at $15.32 billion in August 2026, covering 6.6 months of imports, and the trade surplus reached $13.55 billion in the first eight months of the year.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Dependence on oil revenues	Oil provides over 90% of exports and a large share of fiscal revenue, so oil prices and output shape the public finances and the kwanza	Rapid non-oil growth (9.24% in Q2 2026), new upstream projects and expanding mining and agriculture offer diversified entry points
FATF increased monitoring (grey list)	Angola has been under FATF increased monitoring since October 2024, which means enhanced due diligence from international banks and counterparties	Use experienced compliance counsel and well-capitalised banking partners; the government is revising AML legislation and targets removal in 2027, which would improve banking access
Foreign-exchange liquidity	The IMF notes foreign-exchange liquidity gaps and recommends greater exchange-rate flexibility, which can affect the timing of conversions and remittances	Rely on the investment law's transfer guarantees, register investments with AIPEX, and favour structures with dollar-linked or export revenues
Public debt and financing costs	Public debt was 51.3% of GDP in 2025 and the March 2026 Eurobonds priced at 9.25–9.8%	Strong investor demand, an S&P B- stable rating and the Fiscal Sustainability Law support debt management; DFI co-financing lowers project funding costs
Inflation and interest rates	Inflation remains elevated by international standards, though it has eased steadily to 8.78% in August 2026	Falling rates (14.75% policy rate in September 2026) are improving local credit conditions; apply standard currency hedging
Administrative procedures and banking-sector reform	Regulatory processes and some legacy bank weaknesses can lengthen timelines, as identified in the IMF's 2025 financial-sector assessment	The Single Investment Window, tacit-approval rules and the Contractual Regime streamline entry; ongoing reforms are strengthening supervision

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Interior infrastructure and logistics	Distances and infrastructure gaps raise costs outside the coastal hubs	Lobito Corridor upgrades are expected to cut mineral transport costs by about 30%, opening opportunities in logistics, rolling stock and corridor agriculture

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Angola's risk profile is that of a resource-rich economy in the middle of a determined diversification drive, with improving macroeconomic indicators. Inflation and interest rates are falling, non-oil growth is outpacing the oil sector, and renewed market access, shown by strong demand for the March 2026 Eurobond, signals growing investor confidence. Investors should note two practical considerations: Angola's inclusion on the FATF list of jurisdictions under increased monitoring requires robust know-your-customer and beneficial-ownership documentation and careful choice of banking partners, and foreign-exchange liquidity can affect the timing of remittances. Both are being addressed through AML legislative reform and IMF-recommended exchange-rate measures. With reserves covering more than six months of imports, a sizeable trade surplus and a supportive investment law that guarantees profit repatriation, Angola offers well-structured investors access to one of Southern Africa's largest economies at an early stage of its non-oil expansion.

MARKET ACCESS

Angola is a member of the Southern African Development Community (SADC) and has recently acceded to the SADC Free Trade Area, while developing its national strategy under the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA). It is a WTO member and, having left OPEC in December 2023, sets its own oil production policy. China takes about 47% of exports, followed by India (11.8%) and Indonesia (6.4%), with oil the dominant export and diamonds a growing second. The Lobito Corridor, linking the Port of Lobito by rail to the Copperbelts of the Democratic Republic of the Congo and Zambia and supported by US, South African and African Development Bank financing, is positioning Angola as an Atlantic gateway for regional mineral and agricultural trade. Bilateral agreements continue to expand, including a double-taxation treaty and investment-protection agreement signed with Serbia in 2026.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the President (João Lourenço)	Sets economic reform, diversification and privatisation policy; President since 2017 and African Union Chairperson in 2025–26	Primary reference point for Angola's strategic direction and flagship projects
AIPEX (Agency for Private Investment and Export Promotion)	Sole investment regulatory and promotion agency; registers projects and negotiates Contractual Regime incentives	First point of contact for market entry, registration and incentive negotiation
Banco Nacional de Angola (Governor Manuel Tiago Dias)	Central bank; sets monetary policy and foreign-exchange rules and leads banking-sector reform	Relevant for currency, repatriation and banking matters
Ministry of Finance	Leads fiscal policy, debt management, Eurobond issuance and the PROPRIV privatisation programme	Key counterpart for privatisation opportunities and public-private partnerships
ANPG (National Oil, Gas and Biofuels Agency)	National concessionaire since 2019; awards exploration licences and production contracts	Essential partner for upstream oil and gas entry
Sonangol	State oil company refocusing on core petroleum activities, with a planned partial privatisation	Partner for energy joint ventures and a source of divestment opportunities
Lobito Atlantic Railway (Mota-Engil, Trafigura, Vecturis)	Concessionaire operating and upgrading the Lobito–Luau railway, backed by DFC and DBSA financing	Gateway to corridor logistics, supply-chain and agricultural opportunities

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

AIPEX organises investor promotion and forums and operates the Single Investment Window, while the Ministry of Industry and Commerce leads Angola's AfCFTA implementation work. Bilateral business bodies such as the US–Angola Chamber of Commerce support trade and investment links, and the EU and Angola maintain an active economic dialogue. Development finance institutions are highly active: the US International Development Finance Corporation and the Development Bank of Southern Africa financed the Lobito Atlantic Railway, the African Development Bank is funding the Zambian rail link to Lobito, and the Africa Finance Corporation advises on corridor development. The IMF's regular Article IV engagement and major international energy companies with long-standing Angolan operations are useful sources of practical market intelligence.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Angola suits investors with a medium- to long-term horizon seeking early positions in a large, diversifying economy: logistics, rail and mining-services investors drawn by the Lobito Corridor; agribusiness and food-processing investors building on abundant arable land and import-substitution potential estimated at $3 billion; critical-minerals and diamond investors; and ICT and telecoms investors benefiting from the fastest-growing sector of 2026. Oil and gas companies benefit from a well-established upstream industry and ANPG licensing, while privatisation offers entry points for strategic and financial investors. All investors should plan for robust compliance processes and foreign-exchange management.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage AIPEX and register the investment
Use the Single Investment Window to register under the Private Investment Law, securing repatriation rights and assessing whether the Contractual Regime's negotiated incentives apply.

STEP 2: Build compliance and banking arrangements early
Prepare robust beneficial-ownership and KYC documentation, select well-capitalised banking partners, and take advice from compliance counsel while Angola remains under FATF increased monitoring.

STEP 3: Structure for foreign-exchange resilience
Favour export or dollar-linked revenues, plan remittance timing and apply standard hedging, drawing on the transfer guarantees in the investment law.

STEP 4: Position along the Lobito Corridor
Assess logistics, agricultural and mining-services opportunities linked to the railway upgrade and engage the concessionaire and DFI co-financiers.

STEP 5: Track privatisation and licensing rounds
Follow PROPRIV divestments, Sonangol's partial privatisation and ANPG licensing for entry into energy and state-linked assets.